

Course Coordinator & Academy Founder

Akinwunmi Awoyode, MSc, MBA, CIPM (IPMA-UK)

Founder & Programme Director, Housmata Academy
Chief Executive Officer, Property Max Group

Profile

Akinwunmi Awoyode is a real estate entrepreneur, educator, and technology-driven business leader with over a decade of professional experience in the Nigerian and United Kingdom real estate industries. He is the Founder and Chief Executive Officer of Property Max Group, a leading real estate company committed to delivering transparent property investment opportunities, professional property services, and innovative housing solutions.

Driven by a passion for restoring trust in Nigeria's real estate market, Akinwunmi founded Housmata Academy to institutionalise professional real estate education through internationally inspired standards, practical industry knowledge, and technology-enabled learning. His vision is to develop a new generation of ethical Property Advisors equipped to serve buyers, sellers, investors, developers, and mortgage institutions with competence, integrity, and transparency.

His journey into real estate education began with a personal experience. In 2012, while living in London, he and a group of friends discussed investing in Nigeria's rapidly growing property market. Although they recognised the enormous opportunities, they shared one major concern—the fear of being defrauded due to a lack of trusted professionals and reliable verification systems.

Rather than accept this challenge as inevitable, Akinwunmi chose to become part of the solution. He enrolled in a Master of Science degree in Real Estate Management and Investment in the United Kingdom, where he studied international best practices in property investment, valuation, due diligence, finance, and professional ethics. Following his graduation, he returned to Nigeria and established Property Max Group, applying these principles to build a trusted and respected real estate business.

Over the years, he has successfully led numerous property development, marketing, investment, and advisory projects while helping thousands of clients make informed property decisions. His professional experience has reinforced his conviction that trust, education, and technology are the three pillars required to transform the Nigerian property market.

This conviction led to the establishment of **Housmata Academy** and the development of the **Housmata Certified Property Advisor (HCPA®)** programme—a comprehensive professional certification designed to raise industry standards, reduce fraud, improve transparency, and equip graduates with the knowledge and digital tools needed to build successful careers in real estate.

Beyond education, Akinwunmi's long-term vision is to create an integrated real estate ecosystem where certified HCPA® graduates are connected through the Housmata digital platform, enabling them to market verified properties, guide clients through structured property transactions, and connect eligible buyers with trusted mortgage finance partners. Through this ecosystem, Housmata aims to bridge the gap between professional education, technology, and home ownership across Nigeria and, ultimately, Africa.

Academic Qualifications

-

MBA, University of South Wales, United Kingdom (2022)

-
-

MSc, Real Estate Management and Investment, Edinburgh Napier University, United Kingdom (2015)

-
-

B.Ed. (Physics and Mathematics), University of Ibadan, Nigeria (2009)

-

Executive Education

-

Harvard Business School – Management Essentials Certificate

-

Professional Memberships & Certifications

-

Certified International Professional Manager (CIPM), International Professional Managers Association (IPMA-UK)

-
-

International Member, National Association of REALTORS® (NAR), USA

-

Professional Experience

-

Founder & Programme Director, Housmata Academy

-

-

Chief Executive Officer, Property Max Group

-

-

Real Estate Entrepreneur

-

-

Property Investment Consultant

-

-

Property Marketing Strategist

-

-

Real Estate Trainer and Industry Speaker

-

Vision for Housmata Academy

To establish Africa's leading professional real estate academy by developing ethical, technology-enabled Property Advisors who inspire confidence, promote transparency, and contribute to a more trusted and accessible property market.

Role in the HCPA® Programme

As Course Coordinator and Academy Founder, Akinwunmi Awoyode is responsible for:

-

Defining the academic vision and strategic direction of the HCPA® programme.

-

-

Designing and approving the curriculum framework.

-
-

Ensuring alignment between academic content and industry best practices.

-
-

Providing oversight for instructional design, assessments, and certification standards.

-
-

Leading collaboration between curriculum developers, software engineers, UI/UX designers, video production teams, and industry partners.

-
-

Maintaining quality assurance across all learning resources and LMS content.

-
-

Driving continuous curriculum improvement based on industry trends, technology, learner feedback, and stakeholder engagement.

-

Message to the Development Team

The HCPA® Programme is not intended to be another online course. It is the foundation of a professional ecosystem that integrates education, technology, verified property transactions, and mortgage accessibility. Every design decision—whether related to curriculum, user experience, assessments, or software functionality—should reinforce our core mission: **to build trust in the Nigerian property market by developing competent, ethical, and technology-enabled Property Advisors.**

Welcome to Housmata Academy

My Story: Why Housmata Academy Exists

My name is **Akinwunmi Awoyode**, and before I became a real estate entrepreneur, I was simply a Nigerian living abroad with a dream shared by many in the diaspora—to own property back home.

In 2012, while living in the United Kingdom, I sat with a group of Nigerian friends discussing the remarkable growth of Nigeria's real estate market. We talked about the opportunities in emerging cities like Ibadan, Lagos, and other fast-growing locations. We wanted to invest in land and property while prices were still affordable.

But despite our excitement, one concern overshadowed every conversation.

What if we were defrauded?

That fear was real.

We had all heard stories of people buying land that belonged to someone else, paying for properties with defective titles, dealing with unprofessional agents, or losing their hard-earned savings through fraudulent transactions.

The opportunity was enormous, but so was the risk.

That conversation changed my life.

Rather than accept that this was simply how business was done, I asked myself a different question:

"What would it take to build a property market where trust becomes the foundation of every transaction?"

I realised that if I wanted to be part of the solution, I first needed to understand how mature property markets operate.

In 2014, I enrolled for a Master's degree in Real Estate Management and Investment in the United Kingdom. I wanted to study the systems, professional standards, ethics, valuation methods, verification processes, and institutional frameworks that make property transactions safer and more transparent.

After completing my studies, I returned to Nigeria with a clear mission.

Not merely to sell land.

Not merely to build another real estate company.

But to help raise the standard of professionalism within our industry.

That vision gave birth to **Property Max**, a company built on transparency, proper documentation, client education, and ethical business practices.

Over the past eleven years, we have helped thousands of people buy and invest in property with greater confidence. Along the way, we have learned valuable lessons, developed practical systems, and built a reputation founded on trust.

But I soon realised that one company alone cannot transform an industry.

To truly change the Nigerian property market, we must develop people.

We must train professionals.

We must build systems.

We must embrace technology.

And we must create a culture where buyers, sellers, developers, financiers, and advisors can transact with confidence.

That is why Housmata Academy was created.

Housmata Academy is more than a training institution.

It is a movement to produce a new generation of ethical, technology-enabled Property Advisors who understand that every property transaction carries someone's dream, life's savings, or future investment.

Our graduates are not trained merely to sell.

They are trained to verify.

To advise.

To educate.

To protect.

To build trust.

Through the Housmata platform, they will use technology to market verified properties, connect buyers with trusted financing partners, and help shape a more transparent and professional Nigerian real estate market.

If you are joining this Academy, you are becoming part of something much bigger than a course.

You are joining a mission.

A mission to restore confidence in Nigerian real estate.

A mission to make property ownership safer and more accessible.

A mission to redefine what it means to be a property professional.

Welcome to Housmata Academy.

Together, let us build trust, one property transaction at a time.

Housmata Certified Property Advisor (HCPA)

Professional Certification Programme

Duration: 8–10 Weeks

Target Audience

- Aspiring Realtors
- Existing Estate Agents
- Property Marketers
- Entrepreneurs
- NYSC Members
- Graduates
- Diaspora Representatives
- Property Developers' Sales Teams

ORIENTATION

Welcome to Housmata Academy

Lessons

- Welcome from the Founder
- Why This Academy Exists
- How the Programme Works
- The Housmata Mission
- The Career Path After Graduation

Assignment

Write your personal reason for joining Housmata Academy.

MODULE 1

The Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Objective

Students understand the entire Nigerian property ecosystem.

Lessons

1. History of Nigerian Real Estate
2. Why Real Estate Creates Wealth
3. Residential Property
4. Commercial Property
5. Industrial Property
6. Mixed Use Development
7. Land Banking
8. Property Development
9. Property Management
10. Emerging Opportunities

Assignment

Research three fast-growing locations in your state and explain why they are attractive for property investment.

MODULE 2

Professional Ethics & Building Trust

This is where Housmata starts becoming different.

Lessons

Why buyers fear Nigerian real estate

Understanding fraud

Professional ethics

Transparency

Conflict of interest

Client confidentiality

Professional appearance

Communication

Integrity

The Housmata Code of Ethics

Case Study

A buyer loses ₦20 million because of an unethical broker.

Students analyse what went wrong.

Assignment

Sign the Housmata Professional Code.

MODULE 3

Understanding Land Banking

This deserves its own complete module.

Lessons

What is land banking?

Why people buy land

Investment cycles

Growth corridors

Government infrastructure

How land appreciates

How to identify future growth

Risk analysis

Buying for appreciation

Selling for profit

Common mistakes

Case Study

Ajoda

Ibeju Lekki

Epe

Moniya

Ibadan Circular Road

Students learn why values changed.

Assignment

Identify one future land banking location.

MODULE 4

Understanding Property Documents

Students learn

Survey Plan

Registered Survey

Excision

Gazette

Certificate of Occupancy

Governor's Consent

Deed of Assignment

Allocation Letter

Building Approval

Registered Deed

Search Reports

Practical

Students inspect real documents.

Quiz follows.

MODULE 5

Property Verification

One of Housmata's signature modules.

Students learn the Housmata Verification Framework.

Ownership

Title

Developer

Physical Inspection

GPS

Documentation

Neighbourhood

Infrastructure

Encumbrances

Red Flags

Assignment

Complete a Property Verification Checklist.

MODULE 6

Property Brokerage & Sales

Now we teach selling.

Lessons

What is brokerage?

Representing buyers

Representing sellers

Dual agency

Listing property

Pricing property

Winning exclusive listings

Prospecting

Cold calling

Warm leads

Referrals

Networking

Digital selling

Follow-up

Closing

Commission management

Assignment

Sell one sample property using the Housmata sales process.

MODULE 7

Digital Marketing for Property Professionals

Photography

Video

Drone

Canva

AI

WhatsApp

Facebook

Instagram

TikTok

LinkedIn

YouTube

Email

Landing pages

Assignment

Produce a complete campaign.

MODULE 8

The Housmata Technology Platform

Students master the software.

Creating profile

Uploading listings

Uploading documents

Managing enquiries

Managing inspections

Lead tracking

Client CRM

Commission dashboard

Verification requests

Analytics

Assignment

Upload a property to the demo platform.

MODULE 9

Understanding Property Finance

Students learn

Cash purchase

Installment purchase

Developer financing

Mortgage

Cooperative finance

Employer mortgage

Construction finance

Refinancing

MODULE 10

Mortgage Readiness

This module is NOT about becoming a mortgage adviser.

It teaches:

Understanding affordability

Preparing buyers

Required documents

Income assessment

Business owners

Salary earners

Self-employed buyers

Credit behaviour

Equity contribution

Managing expectations

Referral process

Introducing:

ULE Homes

Yalo

Future mortgage partners

Important principle:

The Housmata Advisor prepares the buyer.

The finance partner assesses the buyer.

The lender approves the buyer.

MODULE 11

Site Inspection Excellence

Preparation

Transportation

Safety

Presentation

Storytelling

Handling objections

Closing

Follow-up

Assignment

Conduct a mock inspection.

MODULE 12

Negotiation & Closing

Negotiation

Offers

Counter offers

Reservations

Documentation

Receipts

Contracts

Payment plans

Handover

After-sales service

MODULE 13

Building Your Personal Brand

LinkedIn

Facebook

WhatsApp

Speaking

Networking

Referrals

Authority

Professional image

Becoming trusted.

MODULE 14

Running Your Property Business

Income

Expenses

Taxes

CRM

KPIs

Sales pipeline

Scaling

Hiring

Leadership

MODULE 15

Becoming a Housmata Certified Property Advisor

Graduation requirements

Ethics examination

Practical assessment

Technology assessment

Verification assessment

Sales assessment

Certification

Activation on Housmata

Independent advisor profile

Professional ID

Lead access

Commission structure

CAPSTONE PROJECT

Before certification, every learner must complete a practical portfolio demonstrating real-world competence:

1. Verify one property using the Housmata verification framework.
2. Prepare a complete property listing with accurate descriptions, photos, videos, and supporting documents.
3. Conduct and record a mock client consultation to identify needs and recommend suitable properties.
4. Carry out a mortgage readiness assessment and prepare the client for referral to an approved finance partner.
5. Present the property during a simulated site inspection.
6. Complete a full transaction file, including all relevant documentation and compliance checks.
7. Upload the listing and transaction details to the Housmata training platform.

MODULE 0

The Mindset of a Trusted Property Advisor

Course Duration

Approximately 60–90 Minutes

Introduction

Imagine you are about to make one of the biggest financial decisions of your life.

You have spent years saving money. Perhaps you've sold an inheritance, received retirement benefits, or worked overseas for years to send money home.

Now you're ready to buy your first piece of land.

As you search online, you find hundreds of advertisements.

Every advert promises the "best investment."

Every agent claims to have the perfect property.

Every developer says they are the most reliable.

But one question remains in your mind:

"Who can I trust?"

That question is at the heart of Nigeria's real estate challenge.

People do not avoid buying property because they dislike investing.

They avoid buying because they fear making an expensive mistake.

Some have heard stories of buyers paying for land that never existed.

Others have purchased land only to discover multiple owners.

Some have paid deposits to fraudulent agents.

Many have bought properties with defective titles.

Others simply worked with professionals who lacked the knowledge to properly guide them.

When trust disappears, opportunities disappear with it.

This is why Housmata Academy exists.

Learning Objectives

At the end of this module, you should be able to:

- Understand why trust is the foundation of every successful property transaction.
 - Explain the difference between a salesperson and a trusted Property Advisor.
 - Describe the mission and values of Housmata.
 - Recognise your responsibility to buyers, sellers, developers, lenders, and the wider community.
 - Commit to the ethical standards expected of every Housmata Certified Property Advisor.
-

Lesson 1

Why Real Estate Is Different

Most products can be replaced.

If you buy a faulty phone, you can often return it.

If you buy poor-quality clothing, you can replace it.

Property is different.

For many people, purchasing land or a home represents years of savings, long-term investment goals, and family aspirations. A mistake in a property transaction can have consequences that last for decades.

As a Property Advisor, you are not merely helping someone complete a transaction—you are helping them make one of the most significant financial decisions of their life.

That responsibility demands knowledge, integrity, and professionalism.

Lesson 2

A Salesperson or a Trusted Advisor?

Many people enter real estate because they believe it is simply about finding buyers and earning commissions.

That mindset creates short-term success but rarely builds a lasting career.

At Housmata, we believe the best professionals do not begin with the question:

"How can I make a sale today?"

Instead, they ask:

"How can I help this client make the right decision?"

A salesperson focuses on closing transactions.

A trusted advisor focuses on solving problems.

When you solve problems consistently, sales become the natural outcome.

Reflection Exercise

Think about a time when you received excellent service from a professional—a doctor, lawyer, banker, teacher, or consultant.

- What made you trust them?
- How did they communicate?
- Did you feel heard and understood?

- Would you recommend them to others?

Write down three qualities that earned your trust.

Now ask yourself:

"How can I demonstrate those same qualities as a Property Advisor?"

Lesson 3

The Housmata Difference

Housmata is built on a simple but powerful belief:

Trust should be the most valuable asset in Nigerian real estate.

We are not creating agents who merely advertise properties.

We are developing professionals who:

- Verify before they market.
- Educate before they recommend.
- Advise before they sell.
- Build relationships before they pursue commissions.
- Use technology to improve transparency and accountability.

This is what distinguishes a Housmata Certified Property Advisor from the traditional image of an estate agent.

Lesson 4

Your New Professional Identity

From this moment forward, do not think of yourself as "just an agent."

You are becoming:

- A trusted advisor.
- A property consultant.
- A technology-enabled professional.
- A guardian of transparency.
- A bridge between buyers, sellers, developers, and finance partners.

Every recommendation you make should answer one question:

"If this were my own money, would I still recommend this property?"

If the answer is no, you should not recommend it to a client.

That principle will protect your reputation, your clients, and the Housmata brand.

End-of-Module Assignment

Write a one-page personal commitment titled:

"The Property Advisor I Aspire to Become."

Your reflection should answer:

1. Why did you enroll in Housmata Academy?
2. What kind of reputation do you want to build?
3. How will you contribute to restoring trust in the Nigerian property market?
4. What ethical principles will guide your decisions?
5. What impact do you hope to have on your clients and your community?

This statement will become part of your professional portfolio and serve as a reminder of the standards you committed to when you began your journey as a Housmata Certified Property Advisor.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 1

Why Real Estate Matters

Opening Story

Close your eyes for a moment and imagine two young graduates.

The first graduate receives ₦10 million as an inheritance. Excited about the future, he buys a luxury car. For a few months, friends admire it, and he enjoys the comfort and prestige it brings. Five years later, the car has lost much of its value, requires constant repairs, and is eventually sold for a fraction of its purchase price.

The second graduate also receives ₦10 million. Instead of buying a car, she purchases a piece of land in a developing area on the outskirts of a growing city. At the time, friends laugh at her decision because the land appears to be "in the middle of nowhere."

Five years later, a major road is constructed nearby. A university opens in the area. Housing estates begin to emerge. Businesses follow. The once-overlooked land is now worth several times what she paid for it.

Both individuals started with the same amount of money.

One purchased a depreciating asset.

The other acquired an appreciating asset.

That is the power of real estate.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Explain what real estate is.
- Understand why real estate is one of the world's oldest and most reliable wealth-building assets.
- Describe the economic and social importance of the real estate sector.
- Explain why the Nigerian property market presents significant opportunities.
- Understand the role of a Property Advisor within the industry.

What Is Real Estate?

Many people think real estate simply means buying and selling land.

That is only part of the picture.

Real estate includes **land and everything permanently attached to it**. This encompasses residential homes, office buildings, shopping centres, warehouses, factories, hotels, schools, hospitals, farms, and even infrastructure developments.

Real estate is not just about physical structures; it is about creating places where people live, work, learn, invest, worship, and build communities.

Without real estate, there would be no homes to shelter families, no offices for businesses, no factories for production, and no schools for education.

Every sector of the economy depends on property in one form or another.

Why Real Estate Is Important

Real estate plays a vital role in every nation because it supports economic growth and improves quality of life.

It creates employment for architects, engineers, surveyors, lawyers, builders, artisans, facility managers, valuers, bankers, mortgage specialists, and property advisors.

It provides housing, commercial spaces, and infrastructure that enable businesses to thrive and communities to grow.

For individuals and families, property often becomes the largest asset they will ever own and a source of long-term financial security.

Why Nigerians Invest in Property

People buy property for different reasons.

Some want to build a family home.

Some are seeking financial security for retirement.

Others are looking for rental income.

Many purchase land as a long-term investment, expecting its value to increase over time.

Businesses acquire property to expand operations or establish strategic locations.

Developers buy land to create housing estates, shopping centres, and mixed-use developments.

Although the motivations differ, they all share one common expectation:

They want their investment to be safe and to grow in value.

As a Property Advisor, understanding a client's motivation is the first step toward helping them make the right decision.

Nigeria: A Land of Opportunity

Nigeria is one of Africa's fastest-growing property markets, driven by rapid urbanisation, a large and youthful population, expanding infrastructure, and increasing demand for housing.

Cities such as Lagos, Ibadan, Abuja, Port Harcourt, Kano, Uyo, and emerging growth corridors continue to attract investment.

Government projects—including new roads, rail lines, airports, industrial parks, and urban renewal schemes—often create opportunities for land appreciation and property development.

For informed investors, these changes present significant opportunities. For uninformed buyers, however, they can also create risks.

This is why knowledge matters.

The Role of the Property Advisor

Many people think a Property Advisor's job is simply to introduce buyers to sellers.

That perception is outdated.

A modern Property Advisor serves as:

- An educator who explains property concepts clearly.
- A guide who helps clients evaluate their options.
- A verifier who promotes transparency and due diligence.
- A negotiator who seeks fair outcomes.
- A coordinator who works with developers, lawyers, surveyors, and finance partners.
- A long-term relationship builder who remains a trusted resource beyond the sale.

Your value is not measured by how many properties you show.

It is measured by how much confidence and clarity you bring to your clients' decisions.

Case Study

The Two Buyers

Mr. Ade and Mrs. Kemi both have ₦15 million to invest.

Mr. Ade contacts an agent and says, "Show me the cheapest land you have."

The agent immediately recommends the least expensive option without asking any questions.

Mrs. Kemi contacts a Housmata Certified Property Advisor.

Before making any recommendation, the advisor asks:

- Why are you buying?
- Is this for investment or immediate development?
- What is your time horizon?
- What is your preferred location?
- Will you require financing in the future?
- What level of risk are you comfortable with?

Although both buyers have the same budget, they receive different recommendations because their goals are different.

Lesson: Great Property Advisors do not sell the same product to every client—they match the right property to the right objective.

Chapter Summary

By now you should understand that:

- Real estate is more than land; it is the foundation of every community and economy.
 - Property is one of the most effective long-term wealth-building assets.
 - Nigeria presents significant opportunities for informed investors.
 - Clients buy property for different reasons, and understanding those reasons is essential.
 - A Housmata Certified Property Advisor is not just a salesperson but a trusted professional who educates, verifies, advises, and supports clients throughout their property journey.
-

Reflection Exercise

Think about your own reason for entering the real estate industry.

Is your primary goal to earn commissions, or to build a respected career that creates value for clients and contributes to a more transparent property market?

Write down three ways you intend to create lasting value for every client you serve.

Author's Note

One feature I would introduce throughout the textbook is a recurring section titled **"From Akin's Desk."** At the end of each chapter, you share a short personal insight, lesson, or real-life experience from your years building Property Max. Those reflections will make the material authentic, memorable, and uniquely Housmata—something no competitor can easily replicate.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 2

The Nigerian Real Estate Ecosystem

"If you don't understand how the industry works, you can never become an exceptional Property Advisor."

Opening Story

Imagine walking into a hospital for the first time.

You don't see just one person.

You meet a receptionist.

A nurse checks your vital signs.

A doctor diagnoses your condition.

A pharmacist dispenses medication.

A laboratory scientist conducts tests.

An accountant processes your payment.

A cleaner keeps the environment hygienic.

Each person has a different role, but they all contribute to one goal—helping the patient.

The real estate industry works in exactly the same way.

Many people believe buying property involves only a buyer, a seller, and an agent. In reality, a successful property transaction depends on an entire network of professionals working together.

As a Housmata Certified Property Advisor, your role is not to know everything. Your role is to understand how the ecosystem works, know when to involve the right professionals, and coordinate the process in the best interest of your client.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- Explain the Nigerian real estate ecosystem.
 - Identify the key professionals involved in property transactions.
 - Understand the responsibilities of each stakeholder.
 - Know where a Housmata Property Advisor fits within the ecosystem.
 - Appreciate the importance of collaboration.
-

What Is a Real Estate Ecosystem?

A real estate ecosystem is the network of people, businesses, institutions, technologies, and government agencies that work together to create, buy, sell, finance, develop, and manage property.

Think of it as a chain.

If one link fails, the entire transaction can be delayed or even collapse.

That is why professional collaboration is essential.

The Key Players

1. The Buyer

The buyer is the reason the ecosystem exists.

A buyer may be:

- A first-time homebuyer.
- An investor.
- A developer.
- A company.
- A cooperative society.
- A Nigerian living abroad.
- A retiree.
- A family looking for a home.

Every buyer has different goals, financial capacity, and risk tolerance.

Your responsibility is to understand those differences before making recommendations.

2. The Seller

The seller may be:

- A private landowner.
- A homeowner.
- A developer.
- A corporate organisation.
- A government agency.
- An institutional investor.

A professional advisor must verify that the seller has the legal right to sell before introducing the property to buyers.

One of the greatest mistakes inexperienced agents make is assuming that because someone claims ownership, they actually have the legal authority to sell.

Verification comes first.

3. Property Developers

Developers transform land into valuable assets.

They may build:

- Residential estates.
- Shopping centres.
- Office complexes.
- Warehouses.
- Industrial parks.
- Mixed-use developments.

A good advisor understands a developer's reputation, delivery history, approvals, and project timelines before recommending their projects.

4. Estate Surveyors and Valuers

These professionals help determine the market value of property, advise clients on investments, and provide valuation reports for sales, acquisitions, insurance, and lending.

As a Property Advisor, you should know when a valuation is necessary and refer clients appropriately.

5. Lawyers

Property transactions involve legal rights and obligations.

Lawyers help prepare and review documents such as:

- Contracts of Sale.
- Deeds of Assignment.
- Lease Agreements.
- Power of Attorney documents.

They also conduct legal due diligence and advise clients on legal risks.

A professional advisor never discourages a client from seeking independent legal advice.

6. Surveyors

Surveyors prepare accurate survey plans, establish property boundaries, and help prevent disputes over land ownership and encroachment.

A survey plan is not just a drawing—it is one of the foundations of proper land identification.

7. Government Agencies

Government plays a critical role through:

- Land administration.
- Title registration.
- Physical planning approvals.
- Building permits.
- Land information systems.
- Infrastructure development.

A knowledgeable advisor understands which government authorities are involved at different stages of a property transaction.

8. Mortgage & Housing Finance Partners

Not every buyer can pay cash.

Many buyers require financing to purchase property.

This is where Housmata's ecosystem becomes unique.

Housmata partners with trusted mortgage and housing finance providers to help buyers explore financing options.

As a Housmata Certified Property Advisor, your responsibility is **not** to approve mortgages or make lending decisions. Your role is to:

- Recognise when financing may be appropriate.
- Explain the financing process in simple terms.
- Help clients prepare the necessary information.
- Introduce them to Housmata's approved finance partners.
- Support the transaction while the finance partner manages the loan assessment.

This collaborative approach allows buyers to move confidently from property selection to finance application without confusion.

9. Technology Platforms

The future of real estate is digital.

Technology now supports:

- Property searches.
- Listing management.
- Client communication.
- Virtual inspections.
- Document management.
- Customer relationship management.
- Market analysis.
- Transaction tracking.

Housmata is more than an app—it is the digital platform that connects verified properties, trusted Property Advisors, buyers, sellers, developers, and finance partners into one transparent ecosystem.

Where Do You Fit In?

A Housmata Certified Property Advisor is the connector.

You are often the first professional a buyer or seller meets, and the one who guides them through the journey.

You don't replace the lawyer, surveyor, mortgage provider, or developer.

You bring them together at the right time.

Your value lies in coordination, communication, and trust.

From Akin's Desk

"When I started Property Max, I believed success meant closing as many deals as possible. Over time, I realised that the best deals were not necessarily the quickest ones—they were the ones built on proper verification, honest advice, and teamwork with other professionals. Every successful transaction reminded me that no one builds trust alone. That lesson is one of the foundations of Housmata."

Case Study

A buyer finds a property online and wants to pay immediately because the price seems attractive.

An inexperienced agent encourages immediate payment to secure the commission.

A Housmata Certified Property Advisor takes a different approach. They pause the process, verify the seller's authority, review the available documents, discuss the buyer's objectives, and determine whether financing may be required before recommending the next steps.

Although the transaction takes longer, the buyer proceeds with confidence because every stage has been handled professionally.

Question: Which advisor would you trust with your family's life savings?

Key Takeaways

By the end of this chapter, you should understand that:

- Real estate is a collaborative ecosystem involving many professionals.
- Property Advisors do not work in isolation.
- Verification, legal review, finance, and documentation are all essential parts of a successful transaction.
- Housmata integrates technology and trusted partnerships to make the property journey more transparent and efficient.
- Your role is to coordinate, educate, and build confidence—not simply to introduce buyers to properties.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 3

Understanding the Different Types of Real Estate

"The best Property Advisors don't sell properties—they recommend solutions."

Opening Story

On a Monday morning, three people walked into the Property Max office.

The first was a young banker who had just gotten married. He wanted a safe neighbourhood where he and his wife could build their first home within the next five years.

The second was a businessman looking for a warehouse close to a major highway to reduce transportation costs.

The third was a Nigerian living in Canada. She wasn't planning to return home anytime soon, but she wanted to invest in land that would appreciate over the next ten years.

Three clients.

Three different budgets.

Three different dreams.

Three completely different property recommendations.

If we had shown all three of them the same property, we would have failed as advisors.

That day reminded me that **our job is not to sell what we have; it is to recommend what best fits the client's goals.**

That is the difference between an ordinary estate agent and a Housmata Certified Property Advisor.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- Explain the major categories of real estate.
- Identify the advantages and disadvantages of each type.
- Match property types to different client needs.
- Understand which clients are most suited to each category.
- Make professional recommendations based on a client's objectives rather than your commission.

Lesson 1

What Determines the Right Property?

One of the biggest mistakes inexperienced agents make is assuming that every client wants the same thing.

The first question should never be:

"What property do I have to sell?"

Instead, ask:

"What problem is my client trying to solve?"

A client may want to:

- Build a family home.
- Preserve wealth.
- Generate rental income.
- Expand a business.
- Diversify investments.
- Retire comfortably.
- Leave an inheritance for future generations.

Understanding the "why" behind the purchase is more important than understanding the property itself.

Lesson 2

Residential Property

Residential properties are designed primarily for people to live in.

Examples include:

- Detached houses
- Semi-detached houses
- Terraced houses
- Duplexes
- Bungalows
- Apartments
- Blocks of flats
- Student accommodation
- Serviced apartments

Who Buys Residential Property?

- Families
- Young professionals
- Retirees
- First-time buyers
- Diaspora Nigerians
- Investors seeking rental income

Advantages

- Consistent demand.
- Potential rental income.
- Long-term appreciation.
- Easier to finance than many commercial properties.
- Emotional value as a family home.

Challenges

- Maintenance costs.
 - Tenant management (for investors).
 - Service charges in some developments.
 - Market fluctuations.
-

Lesson 3

Commercial Property

Commercial properties are designed for business activities.

Examples include:

- Office buildings
- Retail shops
- Shopping plazas
- Hotels
- Restaurants
- Event centres
- Medical facilities

Who Buys Commercial Property?

- Business owners
- Corporate organisations
- Institutional investors
- High-net-worth individuals

Advantages

- Higher rental income potential.
- Longer lease agreements.
- Strong returns in prime locations.

Challenges

- Higher purchase costs.
 - Longer vacancy periods.
 - More specialised management.
 - Greater sensitivity to economic conditions.
-

Lesson 4

Industrial Property

Industrial properties support manufacturing, logistics, and storage.

Examples include:

- Warehouses
- Factories
- Distribution centres
- Industrial estates
- Cold storage facilities

These properties are often purchased or leased by businesses rather than individuals.

As a Property Advisor, you may not sell industrial property every day, but you should understand its purpose and investment potential.

Lesson 5

Agricultural Property

Agricultural land is used for farming, livestock, plantations, and agribusiness.

In recent years, commercial agriculture has attracted increasing investor interest.

Clients may purchase agricultural land for:

- Crop production.
- Livestock farming.
- Fish farming.
- Agro-processing.
- Long-term land appreciation.

However, advisors must also understand zoning regulations and government policies affecting agricultural land before making recommendations.

Lesson 6

Mixed-Use Developments

Modern cities increasingly combine residential, commercial, recreational, and office spaces within one integrated development.

Examples include developments where people can:

- Live.
- Work.
- Shop.
- Exercise.
- Relax.

—all without travelling long distances.

Mixed-use developments often appeal to investors because they create multiple income streams and vibrant communities.

Lesson 7

Land Banking

Many people think land banking simply means buying cheap land.

That is a misunderstanding.

Land banking is the strategic purchase of land in locations expected to experience significant growth over time.

Successful land banking requires careful research, patience, and due diligence.

When done correctly, land banking can produce substantial capital appreciation.

When done poorly, it can tie up money in locations with little or no future demand.

This topic is so important that we will dedicate an entire module to it later in this programme.

Lesson 8

Investment Property vs. Personal Property

Not every property should be viewed through the same lens.

A family home may be purchased for comfort and security.

An investment property is purchased primarily to generate financial returns.

The questions you ask each client will differ depending on their objectives.

A Housmata Property Advisor understands these differences and tailors advice accordingly.

From Akin's Desk

"One of the biggest mistakes I made early in my career was assuming that if a client liked a property, I should help them buy it immediately. Experience taught me that enthusiasm is not the same as suitability. Today, I ask far more questions than I did eleven years ago. Sometimes the best advice I give is recommending that a client **does not buy** a particular property. Ironically, those honest conversations have earned me more referrals than any sales pitch ever could."

Case Study

Mr. Samuel has ₦20 million.

An inexperienced agent immediately recommends a luxury apartment because it carries a higher commission.

A Housmata Property Advisor begins differently.

After a detailed conversation, the advisor learns that:

- Mr. Samuel lives abroad.
- He has no plans to return to Nigeria for at least ten years.
- His primary objective is long-term wealth creation.
- He does not want the responsibilities of maintaining a building.

Instead of recommending an apartment, the advisor presents carefully selected land banking opportunities in emerging growth corridors, explaining both the opportunities and the associated risks.

The recommendation is based on the client's goals—not on the advisor's commission.

Practical Exercise

You are meeting four clients.

Recommend the most suitable property category for each and explain your reasoning.

Client A: A newly married couple planning to build a home within five years.

Client B: A supermarket chain looking to open a new branch.

Client C: A Nigerian in the UK seeking long-term capital appreciation without immediate development.

Client D: A manufacturing company expanding its production capacity.

Chapter Summary

In this chapter, you learned that:

- Different property types serve different purposes.
 - Great Property Advisors begin by understanding the client's objectives.
 - Residential, commercial, industrial, agricultural, and mixed-use properties each have unique characteristics.
 - Land banking is a strategic investment approach that requires careful analysis.
 - Professional advice is built on suitability, not commission.
-

End-of-Chapter Reflection

Write a short response to this question:

"If my commission were exactly the same regardless of the property I recommend, would I still advise my client to buy the same property? Why or why not?"

This question will accompany you throughout your career. If you can answer it honestly, you will be well on your way to becoming the kind of Property Advisor clients trust with their life savings.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 4

Why Property Values Increase

"People don't make money simply because they bought land. They make money because they bought the right land, in the right place, at the right time."

Opening Story

In 2015, a client visited our office looking for land in Ibadan.

After discussing his goals and budget, we recommended a location that was still largely undeveloped. There were few houses, untarred roads, and very little commercial activity.

He smiled politely but said,

"Akin, this place is too far. Nothing is happening here."

Instead, he bought land in another location because it already looked developed.

A few years later, major infrastructure projects transformed the area we had originally recommended. New roads were built. Residential estates sprang up. Commercial developments followed. Land values multiplied several times over.

The client called me one afternoon.

He laughed and said,

"I wasn't buying land. I was buying what I could see. You were buying what was coming."

That conversation taught me an important lesson.

Successful property investors don't just see today's landscape—they learn to recognise tomorrow's opportunities.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- Explain why property values change.
- Identify the key drivers of appreciation.

- Distinguish between speculation and informed investment.
 - Recognise early signs of future growth.
 - Guide clients using facts rather than assumptions.
-

Lesson 1

Land Does Not Appreciate by Magic

One of the biggest misconceptions in Nigeria is the statement:

"Land never depreciates."

That statement is incomplete.

Land has the potential to appreciate, but appreciation depends on several factors.

Some land doubles in value within a few years.

Some remains almost unchanged for decades.

The difference is rarely luck.

It is usually the result of location, demand, infrastructure, economic activity, and planning.

As a Property Advisor, never promise clients that a property **will** appreciate. Instead, help them understand the factors that may influence future value.

Lesson 2

Infrastructure Creates Value

One of the strongest drivers of property appreciation is infrastructure.

Examples include:

- New highways.
- Bridges.
- Rail lines.
- Airports.
- Universities.
- Hospitals.
- Industrial parks.

- Government secretariats.
- Shopping centres.
- Power projects.

Infrastructure attracts people.

People create demand.

Demand increases property values.

This is why experienced investors pay close attention to government development plans and major private-sector projects.

Lesson 3

Population Growth

People need places to live, work, learn, shop, and worship.

As populations grow, demand for land and buildings generally increases.

Cities experiencing rapid population growth often require:

- More housing.
- More schools.
- More hospitals.
- More offices.
- More retail space.
- Better transport.

Where demand grows faster than supply, property values often rise.

Lesson 4

Economic Activity

Property performs best where people can earn a living.

Ask yourself:

- Are businesses moving into the area?
- Are industries being established?
- Are jobs being created?
- Are people relocating there?

Economic activity attracts residents, investors, and developers.

An area without economic opportunities may struggle to sustain long-term property demand.

Lesson 5

Government Planning Matters

Many successful investors study government plans before buying land.

Important questions include:

- Is the area within an approved development plan?
- Are major roads proposed?
- Is the land affected by future public projects?
- Are there zoning restrictions?
- Are there environmental concerns?

Professional advice is based on research, not rumours.

Lesson 6

Supply and Demand

Like every market, property values are influenced by supply and demand.

When many people want to buy property in a location where few plots are available, prices often increase.

When supply greatly exceeds demand, prices may remain stable or even decline.

Understanding this principle helps advisors explain market behaviour to clients without making unrealistic promises.

Lesson 7

Reputation and Confidence

Trust also affects value.

Properties developed by reputable companies with proper documentation and a history of delivering on their promises often attract stronger demand.

Similarly, locations known for secure ownership records and organised developments tend to inspire greater buyer confidence.

Confidence encourages investment.

Lesson 8

The Danger of Speculation

Not every story of rapid appreciation will repeat itself.

A professional Property Advisor must distinguish between:

- **Evidence-based opportunity**, supported by infrastructure, planning, and demand.

and

- **Speculation**, based solely on rumours, social media hype, or unrealistic promises.

Never encourage clients to invest because "everyone is buying there."

Encourage them to invest because the facts support the opportunity.

The Housmata Growth Analysis Framework

Before recommending land as an investment, every Housmata Property Advisor should ask:

G – Government Plans

Are there approved public projects or policies that may influence growth?

R – Road and Infrastructure

Are there existing or planned roads, utilities, schools, hospitals, or transport links?

O – Occupancy

Are people already moving into the area? Are homes and businesses being developed?

W – Wealth Drivers

What economic activities are creating jobs and attracting investment?

T – Titles and Transparency

Can the property be properly verified? Are the ownership and documentation clear?

H – Horizon

What is the expected investment timeframe? Is the client prepared to hold the investment if necessary?

This **GROWTH Framework** becomes a practical tool students can apply throughout their careers.

From Akin's Desk

"One of the questions I hear most often is, 'Sir, where is the next Ibeju-Lekki?' My answer is always the same: stop looking for names and start looking for principles. Every successful investment location had certain characteristics before it became popular. Learn to identify those characteristics, and you won't need to follow the crowd—you'll arrive before it."

Case Study

Two investors each have ₦15 million.

Investor A buys land because a friend says, "Prices will triple next year."

Investor B researches the area. She studies proposed infrastructure, verifies the title, understands the development timeline, and aligns the investment with her long-term goals.

Five years later, Investor B understands exactly why her investment performed the way it did, while Investor A still relies on rumours to make decisions.

The difference is not intelligence.

The difference is discipline.

Practical Exercise

Choose a developing area in your state.

Prepare a one-page **Growth Analysis Report** using the Housmata GROWTH Framework.

Your report should explain:

- Why the area may or may not grow.
 - What infrastructure supports your conclusion.
 - The likely buyer profile.
 - The potential risks.
 - Whether you would confidently recommend it to a client—and why.
-

Chapter Summary

At the end of this chapter, you should understand that:

- Property values increase because of identifiable economic and development factors, not magic.
- Infrastructure, population, economic activity, planning, and confidence all influence demand.
- Great Property Advisors rely on research rather than rumours.
- The Housmata GROWTH Framework provides a structured way to evaluate investment opportunities.
- Your credibility depends on giving balanced, evidence-based advice rather than making promises about future returns.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 5

Understanding the Nigerian Property Buyer

"People don't buy land. They buy dreams, security, opportunity, and peace of mind."

Opening Story

One Saturday morning, two clients walked into our office only thirty minutes apart.

The first client was a young medical doctor.

He wanted to buy land in Ibadan.

The second client was also interested in buying land in Ibadan.

If you listened only to those two sentences, you would think they wanted exactly the same thing.

But after spending time with each of them, I discovered something completely different.

The doctor planned to build a home within two years.

He wanted good roads, electricity, security, schools for his children, and a peaceful environment.

The second client lived in the United Kingdom.

He had no intention of building for at least fifteen years.

His only goal was long-term capital appreciation.

Both wanted land.

But they were buying for completely different reasons.

If I had recommended the same property to both clients, I would have failed one of them.

That day reminded me of a lesson that has shaped my career:

Never recommend a property until you understand the person behind the purchase.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- Understand why people buy property.
 - Identify different buyer personalities.
 - Discover clients' real motivations.
 - Ask better questions.
 - Recommend suitable properties based on need, not commission.
-

Lesson 1

Every Buyer Has a Story

One of the biggest mistakes inexperienced agents make is assuming that every buyer is looking for the cheapest property or the biggest discount.

The truth is that people buy property for deeply personal reasons.

Some are trying to fulfil a lifelong dream.

Others are planning for retirement.

Some want to leave something valuable for their children.

Others simply want a place they can finally call home.

Behind every purchase is a story.

Your responsibility is to discover that story.

Lesson 2

The Six Types of Property Buyers

Although every client is unique, most buyers fall into one of these categories.

1. The Home Builder

This buyer wants somewhere to build and live.

Their concerns include:

- Safety.
- Good roads.
- Electricity.
- Water.
- Schools.
- Hospitals.
- Community.
- Future family needs.

They are buying a lifestyle.

2. The Investor

This buyer is interested in returns.

Questions they ask include:

- How fast will the area develop?
- What is the expected appreciation?
- Is there future demand?
- What infrastructure is coming?
- Can I resell easily?

They are buying future value.

3. The Diaspora Buyer

This client is often thousands of kilometres away.

Their greatest concern is rarely price.

It is trust.

They ask questions like:

- Can I trust this developer?
- Can I trust this advisor?
- Is the land genuine?
- Can somebody inspect it for me?
- Will my documents be safe?

Diaspora buyers don't just buy property.

They buy confidence.

4. The Business Buyer

This buyer wants property that supports business growth.

They care about:

- Customer access.
 - Traffic.
 - Parking.
 - Visibility.
 - Logistics.
 - Commercial viability.
-

5. The Retirement Buyer

This client is planning for later life.

They want:

- Peace.
 - Accessibility.
 - Healthcare.
 - Security.
 - Stable communities.
-

6. The Legacy Buyer

Some clients aren't buying for themselves.

They're buying for:

- Their children.
- Future generations.
- Family wealth.

Their thinking is long-term.

Lesson 3

The Five Questions Every Advisor Must Ask

Never recommend property before asking these questions.

Question One

Why are you buying?

This single question changes everything.

Question Two

When do you intend to use the property?

Immediately?

Two years?

Ten years?

Never?

Question Three

What is your budget?

Don't assume.

Ask respectfully.

Question Four

How do you intend to pay?

Cash?

Installments?

Mortgage?

Employer Scheme?

Housing Cooperative?

Developer Payment Plan?

This question becomes especially important within the Housmata ecosystem because financing options may be available through our approved partners.

Question Five

What would make this purchase successful for you?

This question uncovers expectations.

Lesson 4

Listening Is More Valuable Than Talking

Many agents interrupt clients.

Professional advisors observe.

Listen for:

Fear.

Excitement.

Confusion.

Urgency.

Family concerns.

Investment goals.

Financial limitations.

People often tell you exactly what they need.

If you listen carefully.

Lesson 5

The Housmata Discovery Conversation

Every Housmata Advisor should follow a structured client discovery process before recommending any property.

We call it the **DISCOVER Framework**.

D – Dream

What is the client's vision?

What are they trying to achieve?

I – Investment Goal

Home?

Rental income?

Land banking?

Commercial use?

Legacy?

S – Spending Capacity

What is the realistic budget?

How will payment be made?

Cash?

Installments?

Potential mortgage?

C – Confidence

What concerns does the client have?

Fraud?

Documentation?

Location?

Developer credibility?

O – Occupation & Lifestyle

What does the client do?

Do they travel often?

Do they work remotely?

Do they have children?

Are they in Nigeria or the diaspora?

These answers influence recommendations.

V – Vision Timeline

When will they build?

When do they expect returns?

How long can they hold the investment?

E – Expectations

What does success look like for this client?

Only after completing the DISCOVER conversation should a Housmata Advisor recommend a property.

Lesson 6

Never Sell from Your Pocket

This is one of the most common mistakes among new advisors.

A client says:

"I have ₦20 million."

The advisor immediately starts showing ₦20 million properties.

Wrong.

A professional first asks:

"What are you trying to accomplish?"

Sometimes the best recommendation costs less than the client's maximum budget.

Your responsibility is to solve the client's problem—not to spend their money.

From Akin's Desk

"One of the most rewarding moments in my career was when a client called me six years after buying a property through Property Max. He didn't call to buy another property. He called simply to say, 'Thank you for advising me not to buy the first property I wanted.' That conversation reminded me that trust creates repeat business, referrals, and lasting relationships. A commission lasts for a moment; a trusted reputation can last a lifetime."

Case Study

Mrs. Ada lives in the United States and contacts a Housmata Property Advisor about a plot of land she saw online.

Instead of immediately sending payment details, the advisor begins by asking questions about her goals, budget, timeline, and concerns.

During the conversation, the advisor learns that Mrs. Ada intends to build a retirement home within three years and may need financing for construction in the future.

Rather than recommending the original property, the advisor suggests another verified location with better infrastructure, easier access, and stronger long-term suitability for her plans. The advisor also explains how Housmata's finance partners may be able to assist when she is ready to begin construction.

Mrs. Ada later says:

"For the first time, I felt like someone was advising me instead of trying to sell to me."

That is the Housmata difference.

Practical Exercise

Conduct a mock client consultation with a friend or fellow student.

Use the **DISCOVER Framework** to gather information.

After the conversation, prepare a one-page recommendation explaining:

- The client's objectives.
 - Their concerns.
 - Their budget.
 - Their preferred timeline.
 - The property category you recommend.
 - Why your recommendation best serves their needs.
-

Chapter Summary

By the end of this chapter, you should understand that:

- Every property purchase is driven by a personal goal.
- Effective advisors ask questions before making recommendations.
- The DISCOVER Framework helps uncover a client's true needs.
- Listening is one of the most valuable professional skills.

- Great advisors earn trust by recommending what is right for the client, even when it is not the most expensive option.
-

Housmata Practice Standard

End this chapter with a principle that students will see repeatedly throughout the course:

At Housmata, we never recommend a property before we understand the person.

This simple statement can become one of the Academy's defining philosophies, shaping how every Housmata Certified Property Advisor approaches client relationships. It reinforces the idea that the Academy is developing trusted advisors, not commission-driven salespeople.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 6

Trust Begins with Verification

"In real estate, verification is not a step in the process—it is the foundation of the process."

Opening Story

In 2018, a gentleman walked into our office carrying a brown envelope.

Inside the envelope were receipts, a survey plan, photographs of a piece of land, and several legal documents.

He looked disappointed.

Then he said something I will never forget.

"I have already paid for this land. I just want you to tell me whether I actually own it."

Unfortunately, by the time he came to us, it was already too late.

He had trusted the wrong people.

He had never verified the ownership.

He had never checked the title.

He had never confirmed whether the seller had the legal right to sell.

He bought first.

He investigated later.

By then, he had already lost millions of naira.

As I listened to him, I realised something.

The problem wasn't that Nigerians wanted to buy property.

The problem was that many people simply didn't know **how to buy property safely**.

That experience strengthened my conviction that every Property Advisor must become a guardian of trust.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- Explain why verification protects everyone involved in a transaction.
- Understand the different aspects of property verification.
- Identify common warning signs that require further investigation.
- Explain the Housmata Verification Philosophy.
- Know when to pause a transaction until questions have been answered.

Lesson 1

Why Verification Matters

Imagine buying a car without checking who owns it.

Imagine paying school fees into the wrong bank account because you never confirmed the account details.

You would never do that.

Yet many people commit to buying land worth millions of naira based on nothing more than a photograph, a phone call, or a promise.

Property transactions deserve even greater care.

Verification protects:

- The buyer.
- The seller.
- The Property Advisor.
- The developer.
- The lender.
- The Housmata brand.

Every successful transaction begins with confidence, and confidence begins with verification.

Lesson 2

Verification Is More Than Documents

Many new agents believe verification simply means asking to see a Certificate of Occupancy.

That is only one part of the process.

Verification means answering a series of important questions.

- Does this property actually exist?
- Can it be clearly identified on the ground?
- Does the seller have the legal authority to sell?
- Are the documents genuine?
- Is the land free from known disputes or encumbrances?
- Does the property's intended use align with planning regulations?
- Are there any risks the client should understand?

Verification is about gathering evidence—not making assumptions.

Lesson 3

The Housmata Verification Principle

At Housmata, we believe:

If we cannot verify it, we should not recommend it.

That principle protects everyone.

It also protects your reputation.

Clients may forget the price of a property.

They rarely forget the person who helped them avoid a costly mistake.

Lesson 4

The Housmata VERIFY Framework

Every Property Advisor should use the **VERIFY Framework** before recommending a property.

V – Vendor

Who is selling the property?

Are they the rightful owner?

A developer?

An authorised representative?

Can they demonstrate authority to sell?

E – Existence

Does the property physically exist?

Has it been inspected?

Can its location be confirmed?

Do the boundaries correspond with the available information?

R – Records

What documents are available?

Have they been reviewed?

Do they appear consistent?

Have relevant searches or checks been recommended where appropriate?

I – Identity

Can the seller's identity be established?

If acting for someone else, is there clear authority to do so?

F – Facts

Do the photographs, descriptions, dimensions, and location accurately reflect the property?

Are there any material facts the client should know?

Transparency is part of professionalism.

Y – Your Professional Judgment

After gathering the available information, ask yourself one final question:

"Would I recommend this property to a member of my own family?"

If the answer is no—or if important questions remain unanswered—do not rush the transaction.

Pause.

Investigate.

Protect the client.

Lesson 5

Red Flags Every Property Advisor Should Recognise

While every situation is different, these warning signs should prompt additional caution:

- A seller insists on immediate payment without allowing reasonable verification.
- The asking price is significantly below comparable properties without a clear explanation.
- The information provided changes repeatedly.
- Different people claim ownership of the same property.
- Important documents cannot be produced or explained.
- The client is discouraged from seeking legal or professional advice.
- Pressure is used to force a quick decision.

A professional advisor does not ignore warning signs because of the possibility of earning a commission.

Lesson 6

Verification Builds Trust

Many people think verification slows down transactions.

In reality, verification speeds up confidence.

A buyer who knows that proper checks have been carried out is more likely to proceed with peace of mind.

A developer with transparent documentation is more likely to attract serious buyers.

A Property Advisor known for careful verification earns referrals because clients know their interests come first.

Trust is not created by advertising.

Trust is created by consistent professional behaviour.

From Akin's Desk

"One of the greatest compliments I have ever received from a client was not, 'You sold me a good property.' It was, 'Thank you for stopping me from making a bad decision.' That moment reminded me that our greatest value is not in the deals we close—it is in the mistakes we help our clients avoid."

Case Study

A developer approaches a Housmata Property Advisor with a new estate and offers an attractive commission for every sale.

The advisor reviews the available information and notices that some important documentation is still being processed.

The developer says:

"Don't worry. We can sort that out later."

The advisor politely declines to market the project until the required information is available and the property satisfies Housmata's verification standards.

Some people may see this as a lost commission.

A Housmata Advisor sees it as protecting the client, the platform, and their professional reputation.

Practical Exercise

Imagine a family member asks you to help them buy a plot of land.

Using the **VERIFY Framework**, prepare a checklist of the questions you would want answered before recommending that property.

After completing the exercise, discuss your checklist with another student and identify any questions that may have been overlooked.

Chapter Summary

By the end of this chapter, you should understand that:

- Verification is the foundation of every trustworthy property transaction.
 - Property verification involves much more than reviewing documents.
 - The Housmata VERIFY Framework provides a structured approach to professional due diligence.
 - Warning signs should never be ignored in pursuit of a commission.
 - Every recommendation should be guided by the question: "*Would I confidently recommend this to someone I care about?*"
-

Looking Ahead

The next chapter should be **"Property Titles and Documentation Made Simple."**

This is where we begin teaching students the practical meaning of terms like **Survey Plan, Excision, Gazette, Certificate of Occupancy, Governor's Consent, Deed of Assignment, Registered Survey**, and more.

Many agents can mention these documents.

Very few can explain them clearly to clients.

That is where Housmata Advisors will stand apart. They will not use jargon to impress clients—they will use knowledge to educate them. That single difference will strengthen trust and reinforce the Housmata brand.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 7

Understanding Property Titles and Documentation

"Documents do not guarantee ownership—but understanding them helps you make better decisions."

Opening Story

One afternoon, a young engineer came into our office.

He placed a file on my desk and smiled confidently.

"Sir," he said, "I'm not worried about this land because it has a C of O."

I opened the file and looked through the documents.

After asking a few questions, I realised something.

He had never read the document.

He didn't know whose name was on it.

He didn't know where the land described in the document was located.

He didn't know whether the seller was the person named in the document.

He simply believed that because someone had said "C of O," everything was automatically safe.

That day reminded me that documents don't protect people.

Knowledge protects people.

A document is only useful when you understand what it means, what it does, and what it does **not** do.

That is why every Housmata Property Advisor must become confident in explaining property documentation.

Not to practise law.

Not to replace surveyors.

But to educate clients and know when to involve the right professionals.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- Understand the purpose of common Nigerian property documents.
 - Explain each document in simple language.
 - Correct common misconceptions.
 - Know when specialist advice is required.
 - Build client confidence through clear communication.
-

Lesson 1

Why Property Documents Matter

Imagine buying a car without registration papers.

Imagine opening a bank account without identification.

Imagine buying shares without proof of ownership.

Property works the same way.

Documents help establish identity, ownership history, rights, boundaries, and the legal basis upon which property is held or transferred.

No single document answers every question.

Instead, different documents tell different parts of the property's story.

Your role is to understand that story.

Lesson 2

Survey Plan

What is it?

A Survey Plan is a document prepared by a licensed surveyor showing the exact location, dimensions, boundaries, shape, and coordinates of a piece of land.

Think of it as the property's "map."

Without accurately identifying the land, it becomes difficult to know exactly what is being bought or sold.

Important Point

A Survey Plan identifies land.

It does **not**, by itself, prove ownership.

How to Explain It to a Client

"A Survey Plan helps us know exactly where the land is. It tells us the size, shape, and boundaries, but by itself it does not confirm who owns the land."

Lesson 3

Deed of Assignment

A Deed of Assignment is a legal document used to transfer the seller's interest in a property to the buyer.

In simple terms:

If ownership is changing from one person to another,

the Deed of Assignment records that transfer.

It tells the story of who transferred what, to whom, and under what terms.

How to Explain It to a Client

"The Deed of Assignment is the document that records the transfer of ownership rights from the seller to the buyer."

Lesson 4

Certificate of Occupancy (C of O)

This is perhaps the most misunderstood property document in Nigeria.

A Certificate of Occupancy is issued by the appropriate state government to recognise a person's or organisation's right to occupy and use land under the applicable land administration laws.

It is an important document.

But it is not magic.

It does not remove the need for proper due diligence.

It does not eliminate the need to confirm that the property being offered corresponds to the relevant documents.

Professional verification still matters.

How to Explain It to a Client

"A Certificate of Occupancy is an important government-issued document recognising rights over land. It is one part of the verification process, not the entire process."

Lesson 5

Governor's Consent

Sometimes a property that already has a Certificate of Occupancy is later transferred to another owner.

Under Nigerian land administration practices, certain transfers require the Governor's Consent before they are fully regularised.

As a Property Advisor, you are not expected to process these applications yourself.

However, you should understand why clients may hear this term during a transaction and know when to direct them to the appropriate legal professionals.

Simple Explanation

"Governor's Consent is generally part of the legal process for recognising certain transfers of interests in land after an earlier title has already been created."

Lesson 6

Excision

This is another term that often confuses buyers.

Historically, some land was acquired by government for public purposes.

An Excision refers to land that has been released by government from such acquisition, allowing the relevant community or landowners to retain recognised interests, subject to applicable laws and procedures.

Different states may have different administrative practices, so clients should always obtain appropriate professional advice.

Simple Explanation

"Excision means government has recognised that a particular portion of land is no longer being held for public acquisition and has been released in accordance with the relevant legal process."

Lesson 7

Gazette

A Gazette is an official government publication that records certain government decisions.

When people refer to a "Gazette" in relation to land, they are usually referring to an official publication that documents matters such as approved excisions or other government actions.

Simple Explanation

"A Gazette is an official government publication that records important government decisions relating to land."

Lesson 8

Allocation Letter

An Allocation Letter is commonly issued by government agencies or estate developers to indicate that a particular plot or property has been allocated to a buyer or beneficiary.

It is an important administrative document within many developments.

However, its significance depends on the context of the transaction and should be considered alongside other relevant documentation.

Simple Explanation

"An Allocation Letter confirms that a particular plot has been assigned to you within an estate or allocation scheme."

Lesson 9

Receipt

Many buyers underestimate the importance of receipts.

A receipt confirms that payment has been made.

It should clearly state:

- The payer.
- The payee.
- The amount paid.
- The purpose of payment.

- The date.
- The property reference where applicable.

A receipt is not a substitute for ownership documentation, but it forms an important part of the transaction record.

Lesson 10

No Single Document Tells the Whole Story

One of the greatest mistakes buyers make is asking:

"Does this property have a C of O?"

A better question is:

"Can we understand the complete documentation and verification history of this property?"

Professional advice considers the full picture—not just one document.

The Housmata Documentation Principle

At Housmata we teach:

Documents answer questions.

Different documents answer different questions.

For example:

Question	Document That Helps Answer It
Where is the land?	Survey Plan
Who transferred the interest?	Deed of Assignment
Has a government title been issued?	Certificate of Occupancy (where applicable)
Has a recognised transfer process been completed where required?	Governor's Consent (where applicable)

Question	Document That Helps Answer It
Which plot has been allocated?	Allocation Letter
Was payment made?	Receipt

A Property Advisor's role is not to memorise documents.

It is to understand **what question each document helps answer.**

From Akin's Desk

"One habit I developed early in my career was never pretending to know what I didn't know. If a legal issue required a lawyer, I involved a lawyer. If a survey required a surveyor, I involved a surveyor. Clients respected me more for recognising the limits of my role than they would have if I had tried to be an expert in everything. Professionalism is knowing when to seek help."

Case Study

Two advisors are asked whether a property is "safe" because it has a Certificate of Occupancy.

The first replies:

"Yes, it has a C of O, so there is nothing to worry about."

The second replies:

"A Certificate of Occupancy is an important document, but let's also review the survey, the chain of ownership, the seller's authority, and any other relevant information before reaching a conclusion."

Which advisor demonstrates professional judgement?

The answer is obvious.

Practical Exercise

You are speaking with a first-time buyer who has never purchased property before.

Using language they can easily understand, explain the following documents in no more than **three sentences each**:

- Survey Plan
- Deed of Assignment
- Certificate of Occupancy
- Allocation Letter
- Receipt

Your goal is not to impress them with technical language.

Your goal is to build confidence through clarity.

Chapter Summary

By the end of this chapter, you should understand that:

- Property documents each serve different purposes.
- No single document tells the complete story of a property.
- Clear explanations build client trust more effectively than technical jargon.
- Housmata Property Advisors educate clients while recognising when specialist legal or surveying advice is needed.
- Professionalism means combining knowledge with humility.

Author's Recommendation

I would **not** end this module yet.

There is one final chapter that naturally completes Module 1:

Chapter 8 – The Housmata Property Transaction Journey

This chapter would bring everything together by showing students the complete lifecycle of a property transaction—from the moment a buyer makes an enquiry, through discovery, verification, documentation, financing (where applicable), negotiation, payment, allocation, after-sales support, and long-term relationship management.

Students would finally see **how all the pieces fit together** before moving into Module 2 on Professional Ethics and Trust. This creates a strong foundation for the rest of the programme.

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Chapter 8

The Housmata Property Journey™

**"Great Property Advisors don't leave important things to chance.
They follow a proven process."**

Opening Story

In my early years in real estate, I believed every transaction was different.

Every client had different questions.

Every property had different challenges.

Every seller had different expectations.

As a result, every transaction felt unpredictable.

Sometimes important steps were forgotten.

Sometimes documents were requested too late.

Sometimes buyers became frustrated because they didn't know what would happen next.

Then one day I realised something.

Airline pilots fly to different cities every day.

Doctors treat different patients every day.

Banks open different accounts every day.

Yet they all follow a standard process.

Not because every situation is identical, but because consistency produces confidence.

That day, I decided our clients deserved the same experience.

Whether someone was buying a single plot of land or investing hundreds of millions of naira, they should experience the same professionalism.

That philosophy is now the foundation of the Housmata Property Journey.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- Understand every stage of a professional property transaction.
 - Explain the Housmata client journey.
 - Know what is expected of you at every stage.
 - Deliver a consistent client experience.
 - Build confidence through process rather than improvisation.
-

Why Every Advisor Needs a Process

Many estate agents rely on memory.

Professional advisors rely on systems.

When you have a standard process:

- Clients know what to expect.
- Mistakes are reduced.
- Trust increases.
- Teamwork improves.
- Transactions become more efficient.

At Housmata, every client deserves the same high standard of service.

The Housmata Property Journey™

There are **10 stages** in every professional property transaction.

Stage 1

Discovery

Everything begins with understanding the client.

Before recommending any property, ask:

- Why are they buying?
- What is their budget?
- What is their timeline?
- How will they pay?
- What concerns do they have?
- What does success look like?

Remember:

Never recommend before you understand.

Stage 2

Property Matching

Now you begin recommending suitable options.

Not every available property.

Only the most suitable ones.

A Housmata Advisor recommends based on:

- Budget
- Lifestyle
- Investment goals
- Location
- Risk profile
- Future plans

Clients should always understand *why* a property is being recommended.

Stage 3

Verification

Before encouraging commitment:

Verify.

This includes:

- Seller
- Ownership
- Documentation
- Property location
- Developer
- Physical inspection
- Available records

If questions remain unanswered:

Pause.

Verification protects everyone.

Stage 4

Property Presentation

Now you introduce the property professionally.

This may include:

Professional photographs.

Videos.

Drone footage.

Maps.

Site plans.

Payment information.

Investment analysis.

Growth potential.

Transparency is more persuasive than exaggeration.

Stage 5

Site Inspection

A property inspection is not merely a visit.

It is an educational experience.

During inspections:

Educate.

Answer questions.

Observe client reactions.

Discuss opportunities.

Discuss risks.

Allow clients time to think.

Never pressure clients.

Stage 6

Finance Readiness

Some clients will pay cash.

Others may require financing.

As a Housmata Property Advisor, your responsibility is to identify the most appropriate path.

Where financing may be suitable, you should:

- Explain available options.
- Gather preliminary information.
- Help the client prepare.
- Introduce them to Housmata's approved finance partners.

The mortgage assessment itself remains the responsibility of the lender.

Your role is preparation—not approval.

Stage 7

Negotiation & Reservation

When the client decides to proceed:

Discuss:

Price.

Payment structure.

Installments.

Reservation requirements.

Timelines.

Expectations.

Everything should be clearly documented.

Professional advisors never rely solely on verbal agreements.

Stage 8

Documentation & Payment

Once terms have been agreed:

Ensure the appropriate documentation is prepared.

Confirm payment procedures.

Issue receipts.

Coordinate relevant legal documentation.

Maintain proper records.

Accuracy matters.

Stage 9

Allocation & Handover

The transaction is not complete simply because payment has been made.

Clients should understand:

Allocation.

Documentation.

Next steps.

Future obligations.

Development timelines where applicable.

This stage often determines how clients remember the entire experience.

Stage 10

Relationship Beyond the Sale

Many agents disappear after receiving commission.

Housmata Advisors remain available.

After-sales service includes:

Checking on clients.

Providing updates.

Supporting documentation.

Requesting feedback.

Encouraging referrals.

Sharing future opportunities.

The sale may end.

The relationship should continue.

The Housmata Golden Rule

Throughout every stage, ask yourself:

"If I were the buyer, would I be comfortable with the way this transaction is being handled?"

If the answer is no,

improve the experience.

The Housmata Promise

Every Housmata Certified Property Advisor commits to:

- ✓ Understanding before recommending.
- ✓ Verifying before marketing.
- ✓ Educating before persuading.
- ✓ Documenting before concluding.
- ✓ Supporting beyond the sale.

These five commitments define the Housmata experience.

From Akin's Desk

"One of the biggest lessons I have learned over the past eleven years is that clients rarely remember every detail of a transaction. What they remember is how you made them feel. Did they feel rushed? Did they feel informed? Did they feel protected? Did they feel respected? Long after the paperwork is filed away, those feelings determine whether they recommend you to someone else. At Property Max, I discovered

that the best marketing is not an advert—it is a satisfied client telling another family, 'You can trust them.'"

Case Study

Two Property Advisors are approached by a couple buying their first home.

The first advisor immediately sends photographs, payment details, and asks for a deposit to secure the property.

The second advisor schedules a discovery meeting, learns about the couple's budget, future plans, financing needs, and concerns. The advisor then recommends suitable verified properties, arranges an inspection, explains the documentation, discusses financing options through Housmata's approved partners, and remains available after the transaction.

Months later, the couple refers three other families to the second advisor.

Not because the property was cheaper.

But because the experience inspired confidence.

Practical Exercise

Using the Housmata Property Journey™, create a simple flowchart showing the ten stages from first enquiry to after-sales service.

Then answer this question:

At which stage do you think most real estate problems in Nigeria occur, and how could following the Housmata Property Journey reduce those problems?

Chapter Summary

At the end of this chapter, you should understand that:

- Professional service is built on consistent systems, not guesswork.
- The Housmata Property Journey™ provides a clear roadmap for every transaction.
- Buyers need guidance at every stage, from discovery to after-sales support.

- Financing, verification, and documentation are integrated into the client experience.
 - Long-term relationships are more valuable than one-time commissions.
-

End of Module 1

I would end Module 1 with a **Module Assessment** rather than jumping straight into Module 2.

The assessment should include:

- **40 multiple-choice questions** testing core concepts.
- **10 scenario-based questions** where students choose the best professional response.
- **One practical assignment:** conduct a mock client consultation using the DISCOVER Framework, complete a VERIFY checklist for a sample property, and map the transaction using the Housmata Property Journey™.
- **A reflective journal:** "How will I contribute to rebuilding trust in Nigeria's property market?"

Only students who successfully complete these requirements should unlock **Module 2: Professional Ethics & Trust**, reinforcing that ethics is not an optional topic—it is the standard that underpins the entire Housmata certification.

Most schools teach ethics as a boring chapter.

We will teach ethics as **a competitive advantage**.

I want every student to finish this module thinking:

"My integrity is my greatest business asset."

MODULE 2

Professional Ethics, Transparency & Trust

Module Introduction

"People can forgive mistakes. They rarely forgive dishonesty."

Opening Story

In the early years of Property Max, a client called me about a piece of land we were marketing.

He was excited.

He had the money ready.

Everything looked perfect.

But during our internal verification process, we discovered something that concerned us.

There were unanswered questions about part of the documentation.

Nothing had been proven wrong.

But enough uncertainty existed that I could not confidently recommend the investment.

I called the client.

Instead of asking him to proceed, I advised him to wait while we completed additional checks.

The client was surprised.

He asked me,

"Are you saying I shouldn't buy?"

I replied,

"I'm saying I cannot advise you to buy until I am satisfied that we have answered every important question."

A few weeks later, it became clear that our concerns had been justified.

The client thanked us.

Then he said something I have never forgotten.

"You lost a commission, but you gained my trust."

That client has since referred several other clients to us.

Why?

Because trust compounds just like investment returns.

One honest decision created years of business.

That is the Housmata way.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this module, students will:

- Understand professional ethics.
 - Build a reputation clients can trust.
 - Learn how ethical behaviour creates long-term income.
 - Recognise conflicts of interest.
 - Understand transparency.
 - Learn the Housmata Code of Professional Conduct.
-

Chapter 1

Why Ethics Pays More Than Commission

What Is Ethics?

Ethics simply means:

Doing the right thing, even when nobody is watching.

It is not about being perfect.

It is about consistently making decisions that protect your client.

Why Ethics Matters

Imagine two advisors.

Advisor A closes twenty transactions this year.

Advisor B closes twelve.

Five years later,

Advisor A has almost no repeat clients.

Advisor B receives referrals almost every month.

Why?

Because people trust Advisor B.

Trust becomes free marketing.

Trust becomes repeat business.

Trust becomes reputation.

The Real Estate Industry Runs on Trust

Unlike many businesses,

clients cannot immediately verify whether your advice is correct.

They trust you.

That trust is your licence to operate.

Lose it once,

and rebuilding it may take years.

Reputation Is Like a Bank Account

Imagine your reputation as a bank account.

Every honest action is a deposit.

Every kept promise is a deposit.

Every transparent conversation is a deposit.

Every time you protect a client,

you make another deposit.

Dishonesty makes withdrawals.

Broken promises make withdrawals.

Hidden information makes withdrawals.

Eventually,

if withdrawals exceed deposits,

your reputation becomes bankrupt.

Money can be recovered.

Reputation is much harder to recover.

The Housmata Principle

At Housmata we believe:

Protect the client first. The commission will follow.

From Akin's Desk

"Looking back over the last eleven years, I cannot remember every commission I have earned. But I clearly remember every difficult conversation where I advised a client against making a bad decision. Those conversations shaped the reputation of Property Max far more than any advertising campaign. Reputation is built one decision at a time."

Case Study

An advisor discovers that another property carries a higher commission than the one best suited to the client's needs.

Should the advisor recommend the more expensive property because it generates more income?

A Housmata Advisor asks a different question:

"Which property best serves the client's objective?"

The answer determines the recommendation.

Not the commission.

Practical Exercise

Think about a time when someone earned your trust.

What did they do?

Now think about someone who lost your trust.

What caused it?

Write five behaviours you will practise to become a trusted Property Advisor.

Chapter Summary

At the end of this chapter you should understand:

- Ethics is good business.
 - Trust creates referrals.
 - Reputation compounds over time.
 - Short-term commissions should never outweigh long-term credibility.
 - A Housmata Advisor protects the client first.
-

Housmata Quote of the Week

Every module should have a memorable quote.

The first one is:

"Commission feeds you today. Reputation feeds you for life."

Curriculum Note (A Strategic Suggestion)

I want to pause briefly—not as the writer, but as someone helping you build an institution.

I think **Housmata Academy should have its own original philosophy**, just as Harvard has case studies and Disney has customer service principles.

We should develop what I would call the:

The 10 Housmata Principles

These ten principles would appear throughout the entire Academy, in the Housmata App, on certificates, on advisor ID cards, and even in offices. Every graduate should be able to recite them from memory.

For example:

1. **People Before Property** – Understand the client before recommending a property.
2. **Verify Before You Market** – Never advertise what you cannot verify.
3. **Truth Builds Trust** – Never exaggerate or conceal material facts.
4. **Knowledge Before Opinion** – Research before advising.
5. **Every Client Is Family** – Recommend only what you would confidently recommend to those you care about.
6. **Documentation Protects Everyone** – If it isn't properly documented, it isn't complete.
7. **Technology Creates Transparency** – Use digital tools to improve accountability and service.
8. **Partnership Over Pressure** – Guide clients; never manipulate them.
9. **Relationships Outlast Transactions** – Your career is built on repeat business and referrals.
10. **Leave the Industry Better Than You Found It** – Every Housmata Advisor is an ambassador for a more transparent Nigerian property market.

The Housmata Professional Oath

Every student will stand during graduation and read it aloud before receiving their certificate.

Imagine hundreds of graduates saying these words together.

That moment alone will distinguish Housmata from every other real estate training institution.

MODULE 2

Chapter 2

The Housmata Professional Oath

"Professionalism begins with a promise."

Opening Story

During my Master's degree in the United Kingdom, one thing fascinated me.

Real estate wasn't respected simply because professionals had university degrees.

It was respected because professionals operated within systems.

They had standards.

They had accountability.

They had ethics.

Most importantly,

they understood that the public trusted them with one of the largest financial decisions people would ever make.

That stayed with me.

When I returned to Nigeria and founded Property Max, I knew that if we truly wanted to change our industry, we needed more than marketing.

We needed standards.

That vision eventually became Housmata.

Today, you are not simply learning how to sell property.

You are joining a profession.

And every profession begins with a promise.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter you will:

- Understand why professional standards matter.
 - Learn the commitments expected of every Housmata Advisor.
 - Understand your responsibility to clients.
 - Appreciate why trust is earned before it is expected.
-

Why Do Professions Have Oaths?

Imagine boarding an aircraft and hearing the pilot announce:

"Don't worry.

I've never had any formal training.

I don't follow any procedures.

I simply fly based on experience."

Would you stay on the aircraft?

Of course not.

Now imagine hearing a Property Advisor say:

"I don't verify documents.

I don't really understand titles.

I just sell whatever developers bring."

Would you trust them with ₦50 million?

Probably not.

The public deserves professionals.

Professionals deserve standards.

Standards begin with commitment.

The Difference Between an Agent and a Professional

An agent asks:

"How much commission will I make?"

A professional asks:

"What is the best outcome for my client?"

An agent thinks about today's sale.

A professional thinks about tomorrow's reputation.

An agent competes on price.

A professional competes on trust.

The Housmata Professional Oath

Every graduate of Housmata Academy shall publicly make this commitment.

The Housmata Professional Oath

"Today, I choose to become more than a salesperson.

I choose to become a trusted Property Advisor.

I understand that behind every property transaction is someone's dream, life's savings, family, or future.

I will always place the interests of my client above the pursuit of quick commission.

I will verify before I market.

I will educate before I persuade.

I will be truthful in my words, honest in my actions, and transparent in my dealings.

I will never knowingly mislead a client.

I will respect the law, honour professional standards, and seek expert advice whenever necessary.

I will use technology responsibly to improve transparency and service.

I will protect the reputation of Housmata, my profession, and myself through integrity and excellence.

I understand that trust is earned through consistent actions, not empty promises.

From this day forward, I commit myself to helping build a safer, more transparent, and more trusted Nigerian property market.

This is my promise.

This is my responsibility.

This is my profession."

Why This Oath Matters

Some people may think this is merely symbolic.

It is not.

The oath reminds us that every decision has consequences.

Every recommendation affects someone.

Every signature matters.

Every payment represents years of sacrifice.

Every client deserves honesty.

When difficult situations arise,

remember your oath.

From Akin's Desk

"There have been times when doing the right thing cost me money.
There have also been times when doing the wrong thing might have

made me money more quickly. Looking back, I have never regretted choosing integrity. Businesses can be rebuilt. Wealth can be recreated. Reputation is far harder to restore once it is lost."

The Housmata Promise to the Public

The oath is not only for students.

It is also a promise to every buyer and seller who interacts with a Housmata Certified Property Advisor.

When clients see the Housmata badge, they should know that the advisor has committed to a recognised professional standard.

That badge should stand for competence, transparency, and accountability.

Case Study

A developer offers an advisor an additional commission if they avoid mentioning that road construction in the estate will begin eighteen months later than originally advertised.

The information is likely to influence a buyer's decision.

The advisor remembers the Professional Oath.

Instead of remaining silent, the advisor explains the updated timeline honestly and allows the client to make an informed decision.

The client still proceeds with the purchase because they appreciate the transparency.

The sale is completed.

More importantly, trust is strengthened.

Practical Exercise

Read the Housmata Professional Oath aloud.

Now write a short reflection answering these questions:

- Which sentence in the oath speaks to you most strongly?
 - Which commitment do you think will be the most challenging to uphold?
 - How will you remain accountable to this oath throughout your career?
-

Chapter Summary

At the end of this chapter, you should understand that:

- Professionalism begins with commitment.
 - Standards distinguish professionals from ordinary practitioners.
 - The Housmata Professional Oath is a lifelong promise to clients, colleagues, and the wider community.
 - Every transaction should reflect the values expressed in the oath.
 - Integrity is not an occasional decision—it is a daily habit.
-

A Vision Beyond the Academy

Akin, I think this is where Housmata can do something that no real estate academy in Nigeria has done.

Don't stop at the certificate.

Create the **Housmata Register of Certified Property Advisors (HRCPA)**.

Every graduate who successfully completes the programme, signs the oath, passes the assessments, and maintains continuing professional development can be listed on a **public digital register** within the Housmata platform.

A buyer using the Housmata App should be able to:

- Search for a certified advisor.
- View their certification status.
- See whether they are active.
- View their verification level.
- See completed training badges (Sales, Verification, Mortgage Readiness, Property Management, etc.).
- Confirm that they remain in good standing.

This transforms Housmata from an academy into a **professional institution**. Buyers won't just ask, "Are you an agent?" They'll ask, "**Are you Housmata Certified?**"

Absolutely. Let's build it as though we are establishing **Africa's leading real estate professional institution**, not simply another online course.

From this point onward, we should think like the founders of a university or a professional body.

THE HOUSMATA ACADEMY

The Housmata Certified Property Advisor (HCPA®)

Building Africa's Most Trusted Property Professionals

Programme Duration: 12–16 Weeks (Flexible Online Learning)

Delivery: Self-paced digital learning, live coaching sessions, practical assignments, field inspections, and capstone assessment.

Certification: Housmata Certified Property Advisor (HCPA®)

Credential: Digital Certificate, Digital ID Card, Digital Badge, and Public Directory Listing.

THE VISION

To restore trust in the Nigerian property market by developing world-class Property Advisors who combine integrity, technology, verification, and financial knowledge to help people buy, sell, and invest in property with confidence.

THE MISSION

To train, certify, and continuously develop ethical property professionals who use technology, transparency, and professional standards to transform the real estate industry in Nigeria and across Africa.

THE HOUSMATA PHILOSOPHY

At Housmata, we do not train salespeople.

We develop trusted Property Advisors.

A salesperson focuses on completing a transaction.

A Property Advisor focuses on helping clients make informed decisions.

When advisors consistently act in the client's best interest, sales naturally follow.

THE HOUSMATA DIFFERENCE

Most real estate courses teach:

- How to sell.
- How to negotiate.
- How to advertise.

Housmata teaches students **how to think like professionals**.

Every graduate learns how to:

- Understand clients before recommending property.
 - Verify property before marketing it.
 - Explain titles and documentation in simple language.
 - Use technology to increase transparency.
 - Prepare clients for mortgage opportunities.
 - Build long-term relationships instead of one-time sales.
 - Uphold ethical standards in every transaction.
-

THE 10 HOUSMATA PRINCIPLES

These principles will appear throughout the Academy, the app, and every graduate's professional journey.

1. People Before Property

Understand the client's goals before recommending any property.

2. Verify Before You Market

Never advertise or recommend what you cannot reasonably verify.

3. Truth Builds Trust

Always communicate honestly, even when the truth is difficult.

4. Knowledge Before Opinion

Research first. Advise second.

5. Every Client Is Family

Recommend only what you would confidently recommend to someone you love.

6. Documentation Protects Everyone

Good records reduce confusion, disputes, and unnecessary risk.

7. Technology Creates Transparency

Use digital tools to improve accountability and service.

8. Partnership Over Pressure

Guide clients. Never manipulate them.

9. Relationships Outlast Transactions

Your reputation is built after the sale, not before it.

10. Leave the Industry Better Than You Found It

Every Housmata Advisor has a responsibility to improve the profession for the next generation.

THE COMPLETE HCPA® CURRICULUM

MODULE 1

Understanding the Nigerian Real Estate Industry

Purpose:

Build a strong foundation for every student.

Chapters:

- Your Story, My Journey, Our Mission
- The Nigerian Real Estate Ecosystem
- Types of Real Estate
- Why Property Values Increase
- Understanding the Nigerian Property Buyer
- Trust Begins with Verification
- Property Titles & Documentation
- The Housmata Property Journey™

Outcome:

Students understand the industry before learning to sell.

MODULE 2

Professional Ethics, Transparency & Trust

Purpose:

Develop integrity as a competitive advantage.

Chapters:

- Why Ethics Pays More Than Commission
- The Housmata Professional Oath

- The Housmata Constitution

Outcome:

Students become trusted professionals.

MODULE 3

Property Sales & Client Advisory

This is where students learn to become exceptional advisors.

Chapters:

1. The Psychology of Selling Property
2. Understanding Buyer Behaviour
3. Building Instant Trust
4. Asking Powerful Questions
5. Conducting Professional Property Consultations
6. Presenting Property Like an Advisor
7. Storytelling That Sells
8. Handling Client Objections
9. Negotiation Skills
10. Closing Without Pressure
11. Follow-up Strategies
12. Building Lifetime Clients

Practical Assessment:

Conduct a full client consultation.

MODULE 4

Land Banking & Investment Advisory

This module will become one of Housmata's flagship programmes.

Students will learn:

- What Land Banking Really Means
- Emerging Growth Corridors
- Infrastructure Analysis
- Highest and Best Use
- Investment Risk Analysis

- ROI Calculations
- Exit Strategies
- Advising Different Investor Profiles
- Building Long-term Wealth Through Land

Capstone Project:

Prepare a professional investment report for a real location in Nigeria.

MODULE 5

Property Verification & Due Diligence

This becomes Housmata's signature expertise.

Students learn:

- Title verification
- Site verification
- Seller verification
- Developer verification
- Red flags
- Fraud prevention
- Working with lawyers and surveyors
- Risk reporting

Final Assignment:

Complete a full due diligence report.

MODULE 6

Mortgage Readiness & Home Financing

This is something no other academy teaches in the Nigerian context.

Students learn:

- How mortgages work
- How Nigerians qualify
- Salary earners
- Business owners
- Diaspora financing
- Credit assessments

- Affordability calculations
- Required documentation
- Working with Housmata finance partners such as ULE Homes, Yalo, and future institutions
- Preparing clients for lender assessments

The advisor is not the lender.

The advisor is the guide.

MODULE 7

Digital Real Estate & The Housmata Platform

Students learn:

- Using the Housmata App
- Digital verification workflows
- Listing management
- CRM
- AI-powered property recommendations (future roadmap)
- Client dashboards
- Digital contracts
- Digital signatures
- Analytics
- Personal productivity

MODULE 8

Marketing, Personal Branding & Business Growth

Students build their own business.

Topics include:

- Social media
- Personal branding
- Video marketing
- WhatsApp marketing
- LinkedIn
- Facebook
- Instagram
- Referral systems
- Networking
- Public speaking

- Building authority
-

MODULE 9

Property Management & After-Sales Excellence

Students learn:

- Tenant management
 - Landlord relationships
 - Rent collection
 - Maintenance coordination
 - Customer service
 - Complaints
 - Renewals
 - Investor reporting
-

MODULE 10

Capstone & Certification

Students complete:

- Written examination
- Practical assessment
- Mock property transaction
- Verification report
- Mortgage readiness exercise
- Professional interview
- Ethics interview
- Public presentation

Finally:

Students take the **Housmata Professional Oath**.

GRADUATION CEREMONY

This should be a prestigious event, not just an email with a certificate.

Every graduate should receive:

- HCPA® Certificate
- HCPA® Lapel Pin
- Professional ID Card
- Digital Badge
- Public Register Listing
- Access to the Alumni Network
- Continuing Professional Development (CPD) Portal

Invite developers, banks, mortgage partners, investors, employers, and government stakeholders. Graduation should become a recruitment and networking event as much as a celebration.

THE LONG-TERM VISION

This is the vision I would challenge you to pursue over the next 10 years:

- **Housmata Academy** trains professionals.
- **Housmata App** connects verified advisors, buyers, sellers, and finance partners.
- **Housmata Professional Institute** sets standards and manages certification.
- **Housmata Research Centre** publishes annual reports on Nigeria's housing and property market.
- **Housmata CPD Institute** keeps advisors current through mandatory annual learning.
- **Housmata Conference** becomes Africa's premier gathering for real estate professionals, lenders, proptech innovators, policymakers, and investors.
- **Housmata Foundation** provides scholarships and promotes ethical real estate education for young people entering the profession.

One recommendation

Because this has grown into a substantial intellectual property, I recommend we stop treating it as chat content and begin producing it as a **professionally published curriculum**.